be deployed when all else fails.[90] Not every ruler wishes to expand his or her realm, but the vijigisu does harbour that ambition. Expansion sets in motion a dynamic of strife. This is a hard-bitten world, but not necessarily an amoral world. Rulers, including vijigisus, are guided by dharma, by a sense of righteous duty – otherwise the unending quest for expansion would be megalomania and sadism. The vijigisu must bring dharmic rule to the world and thereby eventually deliver integration and peace.

Cosmopolitanism

At the opposite end of the worldview spectrum is modern cosmopolitanism. India has an older tradition of cosmopolitanism: this is typically evoked by the Upanishadic phrase *Vasudhaiva kutumbakam* ('the world is one family'). It is in Vivekananda, Tagore, and Gandhi that we get the modern renditions of cosmopolitanism. Clearly there are differences between the three thinkers. What is common is an insistence that the world is plural, with each society and civilization defined by different values and practices. Yet a conversation between peoples is possible and desirable: each brings its own unique contributions and world mission to the table. Key to the ecumenical dialogue across culture and faith is tolerance and an ability to integrate diversity. India, in this view, has a unique message of tolerance and integration of different peoples and religions: it has received and absorbed many peoples in its long history, without exterminating or enslaving them (unlike the West). It therefore has its own special role.

The more radical element of Indian cosmopolitanism is its scepticism towards the state and nationalism upon which modern international relations are built. Especially for Tagore and Gandhi, nationalism is both emancipatory (from colonial rule) and oppressive (it encourages individuals to sacrifice their creativity and moral sense for the collective and to make excuses for social violence). States built on nationalism are inevitable, but for Tagore and Gandhi individual self-restraint and moral behaviour are the key to peace and order: if we all respected certain norms of behaviour